

0:0:0.0 --> 0:0:1.350

INTERVIEWER - MW

Go. Alright man.

0:0:1.130 --> 0:0:1.540

FR07

OK.

0:0:2.60 --> 0:0:2.920

INTERVIEWER - MW

We're live.

0:0:8.520 --> 0:0:8.910

FR07

OK.

0:0:3.790 --> 0:0:17.860

INTERVIEWER - MW

So the first part of the questions are all going to be focused around occupational stress. Then we'll get into like the mindfulness based questions and then we'll wrap up just with any kind of catch all questions and make sure we've hit all the topics you wanna hit on.

0:0:18.330 --> 0:0:18.760

FR07

OK.

0:0:18.840 --> 0:0:22.920

INTERVIEWER - MW

So the first question is, what does occupational stress mean to you?

0:0:25.370 --> 0:0:31.240

FR07

Well, occupational stress through my career has changed a couple different times.

0:0:33.220 --> 0:0:34.390

FR07

In my 20s,

0:0:36.280 --> 0:0:39.170

FR07

Occupational stress was more like a.

0:0:40.190 --> 0:0:40.690

FR07

Umm.

0:0:44.50 --> 0:1:1.700

FR07

It was like adrenaline rush. I was a college football guy, went out on Saturday afternoons and got to play

on, you know, on the field and that stress level that we took in during that time was kind of like the first time that I stepped on a fire ground or an EMS scene.

0:1:2.420 --> 0:1:4.950

FR07

And so that was it was cool. I mean it was.

0:1:6.150 --> 0:1:12.940

FR07

You know you mean you? It you enjoyed the adrenaline rush. You enjoy going back and.

0:1:15.740 --> 0:1:16.900

FR07

Taking it all in.

0:1:17.810 --> 0:1:21.120

FR07

But it's kind of like the the hits on the football field, they kind of.

0:1:22.30 --> 0:1:23.610

FR07

After amount of time.

0:1:25.730 --> 0:1:31.770

FR07

The stress the the level of stress, the occupational stress kind of took a toll on you.

0:1:32.770 --> 0:1:38.130

FR07

And after about [MORE THAN THREE DECADES] in this business, I can say they've taken a real toll on me.

0:1:40.950 --> 0:1:44.960

FR07

Now I'm not. I'm not a typical firefighter.

0:1:46.90 --> 0:1:52.220

FR07

I've kind of been one that's kind of pushed the envelope a little bit, meaning I was a [MENTIONS DIFFERENT EMERGENCY JOB CONTEXT].

0:1:53.670 --> 0:1:58.300

FR07

Also being a firefighter, I also I did both jobs. I worked in a trauma room.

0:1:59.30 --> 0:2:5.610

FR07

For 20 years, so I kind of went from one job to the other job to the other job in the same week. So I work.

0:2:6.450 --> 0:2:13.910

FR07

A day on in two days off the Firehouse and my two days off, I'd either be flying in a helicopter or I'd be working in a trauma room.

0:2:15.790 --> 0:2:18.930

FR07

So I never took a day. I never got away.

0:2:20.470 --> 0:2:21.580

FR07

I also was.

0:2:22.270 --> 0:2:25.760

FR07

Like I said, I was also in the [MENTIONS DIFFERENT EMERGENCY JOB CONTEXT].

0:2:26.590 --> 0:2:34.690

FR07

I've kind of done everything that I could possibly do through this time of my career. I didn't wanna leave one stone unturned.

0:2:36.340 --> 0:2:40.510

FR07

So again, you're talking to a guy that's a little bit different.

0:2:43.60 --> 0:2:44.350

FR07

Because I wanted to do everything.

0:2:45.750 --> 0:2:51.810

FR07

I I grew up kind of different, so I didn't want anybody to say have we could use you, but.

0:2:53.440 --> 0:3:6.460

FR07

I didn't want that, "but" to be in there, I I wanted to have every every avenue covered, so if you needed me in a in a problem that I was, I was well versed in that problem, you might need me.

0:3:8.610 --> 0:3:13.370

FR07

So that's kind of how I that's kind of my in a nutshell of my career.

0:3:14.590 --> 0:3:20.610

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, that's that's, that's fascinating. You mentioned that you know it's changed.

0:3:21.300 --> 0:3:29.730

INTERVIEWER - MW

Over the years and start off with the 20s, what? What were some of the notable changes in this, the stressors?

0:3:30.390 --> 0:3:31.360

INTERVIEWER - MW

From your standpoint.

0:3:36.380 --> 0:3:39.320

FR07

I would say at first probably my social skills.

0:3:40.560 --> 0:3:42.50

FR07

I've become less sociable.

0:3:44.780 --> 0:3:55.780

FR07

I was kind of fortunate that I wasn't a drinker or smoker or a drug user, because that's kind of kind of where we go through with this. So mine was.

0:3:56.560 --> 0:3:58.180

FR07

Anger management problems.

0:3:59.760 --> 0:4:0.190

FR07

Umm.

0:4:1.300 --> 0:4:2.800

FR07

I didn't deal with.

0:4:4.10 --> 0:4:12.610

FR07

After a while I didn't deal with people trying to tell me how to do my job and what I had to go home with, and it even took it even went to my home life.

0:4:14.350 --> 0:4:18.880

FR07

So I would say probably the first part is, was the attitude change.

0:4:19.570 --> 0:4:20.420

FR07

Was the.

0:4:21.210 --> 0:4:24.160

FR07

The social skills I wasn't as social as I used to be.

0:4:29.310 --> 0:4:56.260

INTERVIEWER - MW

We've had, you know, a few people now that we've we're doing more of these interviews kind of speak to that dynamic, that peer-to-peer dynamic. And you know, you got chain of command but then also guys gals may not quite follow that and they have preferences and it creates a little bit of tension in just the collegial relationship. How how's that been for you and kind of how has that contributed or positively or negatively to, you know, your stress?

0:5:6.30 --> 0:5:7.50

INTERVIEWER - MW

Right, right.

0:4:56.440 --> 0:5:12.750

FR07

Very, very negatively, our chain of command is and I, and again, you gotta remember, I'm speaking only about my department and where I work. OK, so I can't. I can't elaborate on what another department does or how they do.

0:5:14.60 --> 0:5:25.970

FR07

But our business went from a service in in my early 80s, nineties, when I got into the business late 80s, early 90s when I started.

0:5:26.630 --> 0:5:31.70

FR07

To the 2000s. Now it went to a very political realm.

0:5:32.60 --> 0:5:33.580

FR07

So instead of.

0:5:36.140 --> 0:5:37.160

FR07

Instead of.

0:5:37.940 --> 0:5:41.160

FR07

Doing what we are trained and allowed.

0:5:43.0 --> 0:5:43.610

FR07

And.

0:5:44.350 --> 0:5:44.870

FR07

Umm.

0:5:45.560 --> 0:5:48.800

FR07

Try to find the words to and and.

0:5:53.880 --> 0:5:55.350

FR07

What we should be doing?

0:5:56.360 --> 0:6:3.610

FR07

We're caught in a political nightmare now that is creating a whirlwind of trauma with these guys.

0:6:4.630 --> 0:6:6.600

FR07

Because they know the right thing to do.

0:6:7.700 --> 0:6:12.480

FR07

Because it didn't politically correct, we don't want to do it. We don't want to allow you to do it.

0:6:13.190 --> 0:6:14.790

FR07

And it's causing.

0:6:17.100 --> 0:6:22.650

FR07

Tremendous stress on these guys. They got to go home and and look at themselves in the mirror every day.

0:6:23.540 --> 0:6:25.340

FR07

And know they could have made a difference.

0:6:26.120 --> 0:6:39.130

FR07

But because of our upper echelon and the politics, and because I wanna be known as this or they, you know, we've got one side of the spectrum or the other side of the spectrum, we're caught in a political.

0:6:40.830 --> 0:6:41.390

FR07

Storm.

0:6:43.620 --> 0:6:43.980

INTERVIEWER - MW

Wow.

0:6:43.610 --> 0:6:46.160

FR07

And it's changed. It's changed.

0:6:48.250 --> 0:6:53.890

FR07

Tragically to, I mean, if you look at police and fire at a as a whole.

0:6:55.410 --> 0:6:57.180

FR07

It's changed tremendously there.

0:6:59.600 --> 0:7:1.780

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, that's that's an interesting could.

0:7:2.480 --> 0:7:3.740

INTERVIEWER - MW

You describe like.

0:7:4.720 --> 0:7:6.360

INTERVIEWER - MW

Scenario to where?

0:7:10.30 --> 0:7:10.480

INTERVIEWER - MW

Mm-hmm.

0:7:5.750 --> 0:7:14.780

FR07

All I could I could describe, we just come out of the COVID era, you know, two years, three years, actually. We were in it through through three years, OK.

0:7:15.810 --> 0:7:16.430

FR07

They.

0:7:17.610 --> 0:7:22.80

FR07

And I don't. And I'm not telling you what to believe or what not to believe. OK, I know what I believe.

0:7:22.830 --> 0:7:25.80

FR07

Because I lived it, OK?

0:7:25.980 --> 0:7:29.330

FR07

Is COVID real? Absolutely COVID is real.

0:7:30.330 --> 0:7:36.220

FR07

Is COVID everything that the political realm made it to be? Absolutely not.

0:7:37.390 --> 0:7:37.930

FR07

OK.

0:7:38.710 --> 0:7:40.690

FR07

Which cost people their lives.

0:7:41.790 --> 0:7:44.740

FR07

And they wanted it to because I watched it.

0:7:45.890 --> 0:7:47.670

FR07

They redone protocols.

0:7:50.210 --> 0:7:51.20

FR07

To match.

0:7:51.830 --> 0:7:52.420

FR07

The.

0:7:57.450 --> 0:8:1.700

FR07

To match the COVID not to match the individual that needed our help.

0:8:2.500 --> 0:8:3.820

FR07

Meaning such as.

0:8:4.970 --> 0:8:8.640

FR07

In my career, I was never disciplined.

0:8:10.0 --> 0:8:14.770

FR07

Never [MORE THAN THREE DECADES], I was never disciplined for job performance.

0:8:17.230 --> 0:8:21.530

FR07

In 2 1/2 years of COVID, I was disciplined over five times.

0:8:23.400 --> 0:8:27.940

FR07

For how I handled a COVID patient such as, I'll give you a for instance.

0:8:28.780 --> 0:8:33.540

FR07

We responded to a [AGE REDACTED] adolescent female.

0:8:34.610 --> 0:8:36.60

FR07

On the soccer field.

0:8:36.830 --> 0:8:39.440

FR07

That was that had a diagnosis of.

0:8:40.250 --> 0:8:40.810

FR07

Umm.

0:8:42.530 --> 0:8:43.300

FR07

Athletic.

0:8:44.220 --> 0:8:47.900

FR07

Sports related asthma induced OK.

0:8:48.520 --> 0:8:51.330

FR07

We get there because of COVID.

0:8:53.30 --> 0:8:54.750

FR07

We're not allowed to give a breathing treatment.

0:8:57.970 --> 0:8:58.370

FR07

OK.

0:8:59.100 --> 0:8:59.580

FR07

Now.

0:9:2.460 --> 0:9:4.570

FR07

Now, me being the guy that I am.

0:9:6.260 --> 0:9:10.860

FR07

I've in his back pocket in his bag. He's got a bunch of albuterol treatments.

0:9:13.130 --> 0:9:20.760

FR07

What does this girl need? Yeah, I got her. We got her settled down, gave her a breathing treatment, got her back on the playing field. She's fine.

0:9:22.740 --> 0:9:25.330

FR07

Or we put her in the back of the medic.

0:9:26.340 --> 0:9:35.70

FR07

We fight with her because she can't breathe. We take her all the way to Children's Hospital, which is on the other side of the city.

0:9:38.160 --> 0:9:40.630

FR07

So they can diagnose her with a COVID.

0:9:42.730 --> 0:9:45.560

FR07

And put her in the hot and have hospital related incidents.

0:9:49.900 --> 0:9:51.910

FR07

OK. That's just one out of many.

0:9:53.250 --> 0:9:56.620

FR07

I had a gentleman that's in his early 70s.

0:9:57.290 --> 0:9:58.880

FR07

That I had taken care of.

0:10:0.390 --> 0:10:5.450

FR07

Prior to COVID, a half a dozen to a dozen times been to his residence.

0:10:7.630 --> 0:10:11.850

FR07

Taking care of him multiple times, he he has heart problems. He's CHF.

0:10:12.970 --> 0:10:13.510

FR07

OK.

0:10:14.430 --> 0:10:15.590

FR07

Congestive heart failure.

0:10:16.20 --> 0:10:16.290

INTERVIEWER - MW

No.

0:10:16.660 --> 0:10:18.910

FR07

I get there. He's got.

0:10:21.670 --> 0:10:31.500

FR07

Bloody tinge. His lungs are full. He's got everything going on. Due to COVID, we're not allowed to intubate anybody in the field.

0:10:33.380 --> 0:10:35.280

FR07

Well, you can't bag this guy.

0:10:36.870 --> 0:10:38.600

FR07

Because he's fluid retention.

0:10:39.450 --> 0:10:40.880

FR07

It's not going to go anywhere.

0:10:41.950 --> 0:10:42.730

FR07

You can't.

0:10:44.300 --> 0:10:47.220

FR07

Cpap, this guy, because you're gonna drown him.

0:10:49.30 --> 0:10:50.860

FR07

So I laid him down, sedated him.

0:10:51.620 --> 0:10:52.490

FR07

Intubated him.

0:10:53.990 --> 0:10:55.260

FR07

Took him to the hospital.

0:10:56.80 --> 0:11:1.890

FR07

Again with the [VARIOUS MEDICAL INTERVENTIONS]. Got him. Got him back. He's back home in [COUPLE OF DAYS].

0:11:5.750 --> 0:11:6.880

FR07

That's two out of.

0:11:7.910 --> 0:11:9.360

FR07

Many that I was wrote up for.

0:11:11.920 --> 0:11:12.290

INTERVIEWER - MW

OK.

0:11:11.550 --> 0:11:15.510

FR07

The other one is as I we had a trauma on the freeway.

0:11:18.230 --> 0:11:20.70

FR07

I mean a very.

0:11:21.550 --> 0:11:24.720

FR07

Very significant trauma into a semi.

0:11:25.720 --> 0:11:27.580

FR07

Took the lady out of the automobile.

0:11:28.510 --> 0:11:29.750

FR07

Healthy as me and you.

0:11:30.580 --> 0:11:33.120

FR07

Put her on the cot, she ends up dying [A FEW DAYS LATER].

0:11:34.270 --> 0:11:35.750

FR07

Again, we get a follow up.

0:11:37.640 --> 0:11:39.530

FR07

Listed on her death certificate.

0:11:40.530 --> 0:11:41.300

FR07

Uh, COVID.

0:11:44.950 --> 0:11:52.460

FR07

Again, COVID is real, I'm not taking anything away from it. I had it numerous times and never missed a day of work.

0:11:53.990 --> 0:11:55.500

FR07

Never received a COVID shot.

0:11:57.720 --> 0:11:58.220

FR07

OK.

0:12:0.140 --> 0:12:0.490

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:12:0.340 --> 0:12:6.50

FR07

But I'm just telling you I was. I was disciplined over five times through the COVID politics.

0:12:6.700 --> 0:12:15.750

FR07

That had to do with my job. I can't look myself in the mirror the next day and go. I could have helped her [YOUNG] little girl, but I watched her suffocate because.

0:12:17.80 --> 0:12:18.670

FR07

Politics told me I couldn't do it.

0:12:19.640 --> 0:12:21.270

FR07

And that's what these guys are going through.

0:12:22.220 --> 0:12:22.530

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:12:23.420 --> 0:12:23.960

INTERVIEWER - MW

And that's.

0:12:23.230 --> 0:12:29.80

FR07

And again, a lot of them wouldn't step up because they're newer guys. They're this, they're that now it's.

0:12:30.420 --> 0:12:32.760

FR07

I feel good about what this decision I made.

0:12:36.250 --> 0:12:38.560

FR07

These guys don't feel good about the decision they make.

0:12:39.870 --> 0:12:40.280

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

[DESCRIBES THE DETAILS OF A COLLEAGUE'S SUICIDE]

0:12:58.200 --> 0:13:2.970

INTERVIEWER - MW

This is this is a. This is a colleague of yours or or associate with them.

0:13:1.630 --> 0:13:3.340

FR07

Yeah, he would work with fire.

0:13:4.60 --> 0:13:10.410

FR07

And if you look at the suicidal around [COUNTY NAME] alone, of firefighters.

0:13:15.700 --> 0:13:16.80

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:13:12.720 --> 0:13:23.880

FR07

I think you're from the Ohio area, right? You're from Columbus. OK, I'm. I'm. I'm didn't mean to, but the Franklin County or the suburbs around Columbus, if you look at that alone, see how many suicides?

0:13:26.20 --> 0:13:27.600

FR07

From firefighters alone.

0:13:29.770 --> 0:13:30.790

FR07

I can tell you why.

0:13:33.50 --> 0:13:39.10

FR07

But nobody wants to. Nobody wants to understand it because it's a very stressful job.

0:13:40.290 --> 0:13:40.570

INTERVIEWER - MW

Uh.

0:13:41.920 --> 0:13:44.570

FR07

You know, I'm saying we got an excuse for everything. I get it.

0:13:50.800 --> 0:13:51.110

INTERVIEWER - MW

Mm-hmm.

0:13:45.450 --> 0:13:55.750

FR07

But I watch our guys, I watch the divorce rate. I'm a divorced guy [MENTIONS CHILDREN AND EX-SPOUSE].

0:13:56.560 --> 0:13:56.910

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:13:56.820 --> 0:13:57.540

FR07

She had enough.

0:14:00.590 --> 0:14:05.450

FR07

So the politics of this job, if they'd let us do it and be able to talk about it.

0:14:06.680 --> 0:14:08.590

FR07

And and respect us enough.

0:14:10.830 --> 0:14:21.500

FR07

We would have never had these problems, but it'll never change because we as you watch the TV every night and the radio listen to the radio every day, you hear the politics.

0:14:24.780 --> 0:14:25.810

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what are?

0:14:27.250 --> 0:14:32.940

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what are the existing mechanisms right now to to help with stress reduction while on the job?

0:14:32.160 --> 0:14:33.590

FR07

There is 0.

0:14:36.520 --> 0:14:36.930

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:14:34.910 --> 0:14:44.980

FR07

And I'm gonna tell you why and I and I'm not. I don't wanna insult you, so don't I. I see a therapist now.
[DETAILS ABOUT THE DOCTOR].

0:14:45.970 --> 0:14:52.660

FR07

[MENTIONS PHYSICIAN'S DETAILS].

0:14:53.870 --> 0:14:56.60

FR07

I've been seeing her for over 6 years.

0:14:58.100 --> 0:15:2.860

FR07

I went through [SEVERAL] different therapists before I found [MY CURRENT DOCTOR].

0:15:4.300 --> 0:15:4.950

FR07

From.

0:15:5.670 --> 0:15:9.580

FR07

Sitting in a person's office holding vibrators in my hand.

0:15:11.0 --> 0:15:16.0

FR07

To somebody wanting to rub my shoulders while they're talking.

0:15:16.910 --> 0:15:17.820

FR07

To.

0:15:19.760 --> 0:15:25.280

FR07

A bunch of medications. They wanted to put in my body that there's no way I could ever work.

0:15:26.130 --> 0:15:26.730

FR07

Or.

0:15:28.720 --> 0:15:33.920

FR07

You know what I mean? Until I found [MY CURRENT DOCTOR] that actually wanted to get to the root of the problem.

0:15:35.140 --> 0:15:36.550

FR07

And again, she can't fix it.

0:15:38.190 --> 0:15:41.140

FR07

She just has tries to get me to.

0:15:44.810 --> 0:15:45.360

FR07

Deal.

0:15:47.190 --> 0:15:49.630

FR07

With the problems that are out there that I can't fix.

0:15:52.610 --> 0:15:55.590

FR07

And again, we don't have anybody to help us.

0:15:57.160 --> 0:16:8.280

FR07

We, everybody says they do and I and again I appreciate you guys doing what you're doing. That's why I have chose to to participate in this cause I think I I'm getting ready to retire next year.

0:16:8.900 --> 0:16:14.910

FR07

And I watched these guys suffering. I mean, I'm telling you, if you walk into our Firehouse, they're suffering.

0:16:16.140 --> 0:16:19.770

FR07

And among the police officers that I that I deal with right now.

0:16:20.750 --> 0:16:32.800

FR07

They're all. I mean, I I, I I live down in [MENTIONS THE PLACES HE HAS LIVED].

0:16:33.530 --> 0:16:33.830

INTERVIEWER - MW

Sure.

0:16:34.140 --> 0:16:50.870

FR07

And I have a training facility at my residence that I do rehab, training for police and fire guys, and I'm it's a gym, basically a gym, that guys come and work out and I do with that. I have more guys out of the military coming over.

0:16:51.540 --> 0:16:53.230

FR07

Telling me that.

0:16:56.390 --> 0:17:4.100

FR07

They just don't feel confident in their physicians because only thing they do is walk in and there's a medication prescribed and walk out.

0:17:7.310 --> 0:17:18.460

FR07

These guys can't take these medications, man, you can't take these medications and and and and provide a service in the community on these medications.

0:17:20.60 --> 0:17:20.960

FR07

It's not possible.

0:17:24.750 --> 0:17:29.950

FR07

You have to learn to deal and we can't. We can't just brush it under the rug. I mean, these guys are hurting.

0:17:30.600 --> 0:17:32.370

FR07

It's not normal what we see.

0:17:34.950 --> 0:17:35.200

INTERVIEWER - MW

Right.

0:17:34.860 --> 0:17:38.440

FR07

It's not normal what we deal with. It's not humanly possible.

0:17:39.410 --> 0:17:42.10

FR07

I mean, I sit down with these groups and they say, [NAME REDACTED].

0:17:42.750 --> 0:17:46.940

FR07

We had to spend three or four years in this. You've spent [MORE THAN THREE DECADES].

0:17:47.780 --> 0:17:52.940

FR07

Getting off of a helicopter and seeing in three or four years what we seen in one year.

0:17:54.750 --> 0:17:56.290

FR07

And we don't know how you keep doing it.

0:17:57.870 --> 0:17:59.570

FR07

Well, it's. I sacrificed a lot.

0:18:0.240 --> 0:18:3.920

FR07

For my career, I wish I'd had sacrificed more for my family life.

0:18:5.180 --> 0:18:7.330

FR07

Because I'm sitting in a very beautiful home.

0:18:8.120 --> 0:18:13.860

FR07

That's paid for that. I'm getting ready to retire. And as you can hear, it's the quietest place you'll ever be.

0:18:14.910 --> 0:18:16.100

FR07

Because there's nobody here anymore.

0:18:19.790 --> 0:18:20.170

INTERVIEWER - MW

Right.

0:18:22.430 --> 0:18:22.650

INTERVIEWER - MW

But.

0:18:24.940 --> 0:18:30.470

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what are the opportunities do you see for incorporating like well, be well-being resources into?

0:18:31.240 --> 0:18:35.210

INTERVIEWER - MW

Your daily workflow. You know yours, a younger colleague, are their opportunities for it.

0:18:36.480 --> 0:18:39.620

FR07

There there is opportunities. If it's not held against them.

0:18:41.280 --> 0:18:47.0

FR07

And that's where it is. It's held against them. It's I mean, back in my day when I started.

0:18:48.150 --> 0:18:52.480

FR07

We didn't talk about anything like this. I mean, we you were known as kind of.

0:18:55.550 --> 0:19:2.590

FR07

You were just weak. I mean it. It you didn't talk about anything like this. But I'm telling you, it didn't so much as the job.

0:19:4.660 --> 0:19:5.740

FR07

It's so much as.

0:19:8.230 --> 0:19:12.80

FR07

The people not supporting the job, if that makes sense, what I'm saying.

0:19:12.620 --> 0:19:12.980

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:19:13.540 --> 0:19:14.980

FR07

I mean, I can sit and talk.

0:19:15.660 --> 0:19:21.290

FR07

I can sit and talk to you about this. If you were a colleague of mine in the in the Firehouse, we could sit and talk and we could.

0:19:22.220 --> 0:19:28.530

FR07

You know, shed a tear or do whatever we had to do and the tone go off. We get back on the truck and we go to work and you wouldn't know anything was wrong.

0:19:30.120 --> 0:19:36.840

FR07

But the department has said don't do this, and every, you know, we used to when I started, we were at the same.

0:19:38.150 --> 0:19:45.190

FR07

Do you have? I mean, I'm gonna ask you this. Do you have guys that you work with day after day after day that you guys kind of think alike?

0:19:46.730 --> 0:19:47.210

FR07

OK.

0:19:48.640 --> 0:19:51.160

FR07

What if every year they give you a new colleague?

0:19:53.900 --> 0:19:58.100

INTERVIEWER - MW

That would make us less efficient. I think it would be some frustration in that.

0:19:58.150 --> 0:19:59.920

FR07

That is exactly what they do to us every year.

0:20:1.330 --> 0:20:16.410

FR07

Every year because they think it makes you stronger by busting up the team, that's like, I don't know, I'm an NFL guy. I'm a football guy, OK? It's like every time you see a Super Bowl team, why don't they make it back the following year?

0:20:17.340 --> 0:20:39.450

FR07

Because all these guys want more money, they dispute. They go different places and the team breaks up and it's they're not as efficient on the field. That's the same way we are and they don't listen to us. They wanna know why we haven't caught this stuff. We don't catch this stuff because I don't know you like I knew the guy that I've worked with five or six years. We only worked 120 days a year.

0:20:40.610 --> 0:20:43.130

FR07

We work one day one day on and two days off.

0:20:44.390 --> 0:20:57.930

FR07

And in that time period I got vacation or somebody's off on sick leave or where TT out to another station. You know, it takes a few years to build up a continuity with each other to know your partner.

0:20:59.700 --> 0:21:6.950

FR07

Well, as soon as you get that little over the edge, they think it's proficient to bust you up and send you somewhere else.

0:21:7.720 --> 0:21:9.110

FR07

Because they read it in a book.

0:21:10.250 --> 0:21:12.30

FR07

They haven't lived it, they've read it in a book.

0:21:14.40 --> 0:21:15.730

FR07

And I'm telling you.

0:21:16.570 --> 0:21:18.40

FR07

The job in itself.

0:21:18.850 --> 0:21:19.880

FR07

Is is.

0:21:20.780 --> 0:21:22.230

FR07

I mean, it's kind of it's it's rough.

0:21:24.70 --> 0:21:26.0

FR07

But not being able to.

0:21:30.910 --> 0:21:37.680

FR07

Put yourself out there with somebody else or that knows you. I mean, there's days that you come into the office and you just having a bad day.

0:21:39.10 --> 0:21:49.10

FR07

That that partner of yours picks you up, he might. He might start asking the questions on the run or he might jump in front of you and say, hey, you sit this one out. I'm gonna take the lead on this.

0:21:50.240 --> 0:21:54.660

FR07

But if you got guys you don't know, they're not gonna do that because they don't know who you're having a bad day.

0:21:55.390 --> 0:21:59.470

FR07

You're not gonna come right out and say I'm having a bad day, but people read you. You know what you're doing?

0:22:1.440 --> 0:22:5.640

FR07

So again, that's, that's the politics that I'm talking about of the business.

0:22:7.400 --> 0:22:9.670

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, that's tough. And you'd say right now.

0:22:11.30 --> 0:22:16.720

INTERVIEWER - MW

Any any means going about trying to cultivate those relationships for?

0:22:18.360 --> 0:22:20.360

FR07

We don't. There's not a good.

0:22:18.90 --> 0:22:20.420

INTERVIEWER - MW

For the team as as they're as they're cycling.

0:22:25.230 --> 0:22:25.700

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:22:21.580 --> 0:22:26.830

FR07

And again, I'm only I can only speak and behalf of my station. I know [NAME OF STATION].

0:22:27.560 --> 0:22:32.540

FR07

That has [MANY] stations they have. They have the great Fire Chief.

0:22:33.540 --> 0:22:43.930

FR07

[MENTIONS HOW HE KNOWS THEIR FIRE CHIEF].

0:22:44.810 --> 0:22:52.130

FR07

Uh, and he understands the continuity in the in the in the, the team building concept with each other.

0:22:54.780 --> 0:22:56.10

FR07

Our department.

0:22:57.310 --> 0:23:8.820

FR07

They don't have any. They don't have any concept of it. And again, you you're looking back on. Well, I can understand this is running like a well oiled machine. This one is struggling.

0:23:10.630 --> 0:23:13.580

FR07

And that's and that's and that's where where we are.

0:23:15.900 --> 0:23:18.460

FR07

But they don't want to admit it, because that means that they're failing.

0:23:19.680 --> 0:23:20.10

INTERVIEWER - MW

Right.

0:23:19.360 --> 0:23:20.380

FR07

And they're not going to fail.

0:23:23.10 --> 0:23:24.940

INTERVIEWER - MW

That was going to be a question that kind of.

0:23:25.760 --> 0:23:41.610

INTERVIEWER - MW

Connect the dots on there so it is apparent like when you look at your department, your team in terms of performance compared to other departments like there's a discrepancy in how you guys are going about your work is that I'm hearing like it's paying for it was OK.

0:23:39.300 --> 0:23:41.950

FR07

Absolutely, absolutely.

0:23:43.300 --> 0:23:49.830

FR07

Yeah, there's a few of us, you know that I I'll say can operate in about any atmosphere.

0:23:51.190 --> 0:23:53.640

FR07

Just because we're done with the bull crap.

0:23:55.610 --> 0:23:58.970

FR07

But there's a lot of younger guys that are coming in that can't.

0:24:0.410 --> 0:24:3.850

FR07

And they are destroying these guys before they ever get out of the gate.

0:24:5.700 --> 0:24:9.830

FR07

I mean it's it's it's a destructional. I'm sitting there and talk to him. I work with them.

0:24:10.710 --> 0:24:14.420

FR07

I tried to encourage him. They tried. I mean it is it is destructive.

0:24:15.240 --> 0:24:20.780

FR07

I I I turned down multiple promotional opportunities.

0:24:21.770 --> 0:24:36.360

FR07

In this business, because I don't think like the upper echelon, I don't think like the politics, I'm not a

politician. I don't care what your skin color is. I don't care what your ethnic background is, I don't care if you can pay the bill or not.

0:24:37.870 --> 0:24:41.90

FR07

I'm going to take care of you. I don't care if you're old or young.

0:24:41.910 --> 0:24:42.780

FR07

I don't care.

0:24:46.680 --> 0:24:47.350

FR07

But they do.

0:24:48.690 --> 0:24:50.730

FR07

Because again, remember we bill today.

0:24:52.780 --> 0:24:56.340

FR07

We we go into different backgrounds, we go into different ethnic.

0:24:57.20 --> 0:25:1.280

FR07

places. [THIS TOWN] is a very, very.

0:25:4.710 --> 0:25:8.480

FR07

We have different a lot of different cultures in [THIS TOWN].

0:25:9.420 --> 0:25:24.230

FR07

I mean, it's very culture. Let's, I mean we have, you know, from Hispanic people to black residents, to white residents to, you know, Indian populations to, I mean in they're they're different ethnic backgrounds and.

0:25:25.250 --> 0:25:27.340

FR07

They're not treated, they're not treated the same.

0:25:28.590 --> 0:25:29.850

FR07

People are not treated the same.

0:25:31.30 --> 0:25:31.590

FR07

You know what I mean?

0:25:32.770 --> 0:25:35.810

FR07

We go into nursing facilities, they're not treated the same.

0:25:37.970 --> 0:25:48.10

FR07

You know, our elderly population is by far, if you took all those backgrounds and you threw them all and you counted them all and you go to our, our, our.

0:25:49.480 --> 0:25:51.390

FR07

The people in our nursing facilities.

0:25:52.190 --> 0:25:53.770

FR07

It's horrendous.

0:25:54.710 --> 0:25:56.210

FR07

How these people are treated in there?

0:25:57.50 --> 0:25:57.700

FR07

Horrendous.

0:25:59.700 --> 0:26:2.450

FR07

And you sit back and go. I I need to make a difference.

0:26:6.90 --> 0:26:6.530

FR07

But you can't.

0:26:8.50 --> 0:26:10.640

FR07

I mean through the COVID, we watched them.

0:26:11.420 --> 0:26:21.520

FR07

We watched them lock them into literally lock them into their room so they couldn't get out so they couldn't interact with anybody else. Their family couldn't come in and they couldn't leave.

0:26:24.650 --> 0:26:31.960

FR07

They would call us from their phones in their room. Literally. I I gave people my phone number, so at least they could have somebody to talk to.

0:26:36.950 --> 0:26:40.460

FR07

And that's the stuff you're taking home every day. I mean, you think you can just walk away from it?

0:26:41.850 --> 0:26:47.840

FR07

I mean, if you're a human being, you can't walk away from it. If you got any kind of a, any kind of a conscious or a.

0:26:48.760 --> 0:26:52.50

FR07

Anything about you? You can't. I mean, you're in this business to help others.

0:26:53.820 --> 0:27:6.200

FR07

How can you just turn around to this this nice 68 year old lady sitting in the nursing home that hasn't had an interaction with a soul in over three or four weeks?

0:27:8.600 --> 0:27:13.170

FR07

And when you do, they come in on all this guard. They've got to all this headgear on this.

0:27:14.480 --> 0:27:17.820

FR07

And they walk in and they, you know, they're you don't even know who you're talking to.

0:27:19.70 --> 0:27:23.380

FR07

That was another thing I would walk in and take all of my face gear off to talk to you.

0:27:25.60 --> 0:27:36.160

FR07

Because they don't even know who they're talking to. They can't even hear half of the time they're they're hearing impaired. They've got less here and they can't even understand the muffled town sounds that are coming out of your mask.

0:27:39.730 --> 0:27:41.730

FR07

And you sit there and you're just.

0:27:43.80 --> 0:27:45.460

FR07

You just sit there and watch the tears fall down their face.

0:27:47.390 --> 0:27:55.280

FR07

I mean, half the time we just sit there and and sit in a chair with them and watch TV for a few minutes just so they can have interaction with somebody.

0:27:59.330 --> 0:27:59.770

INTERVIEWER - MW

The.

0:28:1.190 --> 0:28:1.700

INTERVIEWER - MW

On that.

0:28:4.770 --> 0:28:5.90

FR07

OK.

0:28:3.10 --> 0:28:16.320

INTERVIEWER - MW

Why pivot here? But I'm curious because you're you're well in the fitness component of this and I'm just curious why, if any types of chronic work related pain that you had dealt with overcame, what does that look like?

0:28:17.180 --> 0:28:19.730

FR07

Uh work related pain. I broke my neck.

0:28:21.410 --> 0:28:25.450

FR07

Got hit by a drunk driver in a [NAME REDACTED] golf tournament. I've broken my neck.

0:28:26.230 --> 0:28:28.80

FR07

Have [SOME] vertebrae broke in my back.

0:28:29.150 --> 0:28:34.400

FR07

From a house that I've fallen through a roof all the way to the floor, multiple knee injuries.

0:28:35.530 --> 0:28:38.200

FR07

Now I'm going to tell you all these injuries, I've never missed a day of work.

0:28:40.810 --> 0:28:42.770

FR07

And I haven't called off sick in [OVER TWO DECADES].

0:28:44.980 --> 0:28:50.750

INTERVIEWER - MW

The way you attribute that to just you being you and you got some programming that's facilitating representative.

0:28:49.30 --> 0:28:51.500

FR07

Well, I I I kind of I've got people.

0:28:54.200 --> 0:29:1.0

FR07

I I like I said, the benefit of me and and what I have done in my career.

0:29:1.890 --> 0:29:11.850

FR07

Has also been a bit or some of the the the things that I've done has been a benefit to me in my career.
I've made a good rapport and a good friendship with doctors.

0:29:12.590 --> 0:29:16.900

FR07

You know, rehab therapist, people around the community that I live in.

0:29:18.270 --> 0:29:21.50

FR07

That we trade off, so if I'm hurting or I'm.

0:29:21.770 --> 0:29:26.440

FR07

You got a chiropractic, Sir? I got this like [NAME REDACTED]. My, my.

0:29:27.710 --> 0:29:28.550

FR07

My therapist.

0:29:29.440 --> 0:29:32.880

FR07

I'll call her up and say, [NAME REDACTED], I'm having a bad day. I need to talk to somebody.

0:29:33.540 --> 0:29:35.760

FR07

She called me [FROM ABROAD EVEN] on her vacation.

0:29:38.430 --> 0:29:42.660

FR07

Because I built up that rapport with people that go. OK, I understand if [NAME REDACTED] is calling me.

0:29:43.330 --> 0:29:44.410

FR07

We've got a problem here.

0:29:45.230 --> 0:29:47.200

FR07

And that's what I've tried to relate to the guys.

0:29:48.230 --> 0:29:58.230

FR07

It's a team concept. Build up a rapport in your world that no matter what, there's somebody standing on the outside, it's going to help you out. If this is the problem.

0:29:59.110 --> 0:30:6.850

FR07

And again, I have people around me. The problem is that I didn't do is I didn't allow my family to know what I was doing going through.

0:30:7.920 --> 0:30:12.330

FR07

Because I didn't think they'd understand and I didn't want to put him through the pain that I was feeling.

0:30:13.10 --> 0:30:17.220

FR07

So I kind of put a wall up there and didn't ever never stepped into the wall.

0:30:19.440 --> 0:30:26.590

FR07

So my wife was kind of left in the dark for a long time. Only thing she would see is the anger that come out. She didn't know why.

0:30:27.250 --> 0:30:29.640

FR07

She didn't understand why I felt the way I felt.

0:30:30.560 --> 0:30:35.510

FR07

Why I had to reach out to this person or that person or that person and not talk to her about it?

0:30:36.930 --> 0:30:39.700

FR07

I thought I was doing the right thing, but I probably wasn't.

0:30:42.470 --> 0:30:42.800

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:30:40.830 --> 0:30:43.200

FR07

I can say I wasn't because I lost it.

0:30:44.900 --> 0:30:49.830

FR07

Physically, there is nothing more important in my physical well-being.

0:30:50.620 --> 0:30:53.150

FR07

I built a [PERSONAL GYM].

0:30:53.930 --> 0:30:56.250

FR07

That's over 3000 square feet.

0:30:57.550 --> 0:31:1.220

FR07

That's full of weight equipment. It's just like any other gym you would go to.

0:31:3.90 --> 0:31:9.630

FR07

I got people coming from all over. It's [NEAR HOUSE] because that's how important I lost my father at a young age.

0:31:10.290 --> 0:31:12.690

FR07

At [FIFTIES] from cardiac disease?

0:31:13.500 --> 0:31:15.50

FR07

I said I wasn't going to be that guy.

0:31:18.480 --> 0:31:25.850

FR07

So I really you know, I I was an athlete through school. I had, I I was fortunate enough to play at another at a collegiate level.

0:31:26.590 --> 0:31:38.150

FR07

Uh, I got out of the air and I coached and my background was an exercise. That's what I went to school to be. I actually wanted to be a police officer. [MENTIONS DETAILS ABOUT THE EXPERIENCE] and I hated it.

0:31:39.800 --> 0:31:42.880

FR07

The fire department called. That's how I ended up in the fire service.

0:31:44.10 --> 0:31:53.610

FR07

It was more of a team concept. It was more of a, hey, let's go to work. Let's go to the locker room. The tone goes off. It's like you're going to the game, you know, I mean, let's go to the game.

0:31:54.300 --> 0:32:1.350

FR07

That's kind of how I look at it. That's how I've always portrayed. If I take the day off, I feel like I'm letting my team down.

0:32:2.520 --> 0:32:10.50

FR07

You know, if I take if I schedule a vacation day, they know I'm gonna be gone. We can, we can get my replacement. But if I just call off one morning.

0:32:10.990 --> 0:32:11.660

FR07

It's.

0:32:12.840 --> 0:32:13.560

FR07

I feel.

0:32:14.390 --> 0:32:16.910

FR07

Yeah, I have always made me feel like I'm.

0:32:18.290 --> 0:32:24.90

FR07

Letting my team down if I don't come in strong and and shape, I feel like I've let my team down.

0:32:25.290 --> 0:32:32.140

FR07

But if you look it over the over the years, if I show you we have a I'll just tell you I have a a gentleman.

0:32:33.160 --> 0:32:37.840

FR07

That come in with me. He was [AROUND 150] pounds because we had our physicals together.

0:32:39.50 --> 0:32:41.20

FR07

When he left the fire service.

0:32:42.970 --> 0:32:49.960

FR07

I think [AFTER MORE THAN A DECADE] into it, he he went out on a disability, he was [OVER 400 POUNDS].

0:32:51.300 --> 0:32:55.480

FR07

And drank at least 36 to 40 beers a day.

0:33:0.840 --> 0:33:4.220

FR07

And the guy is suffering like nobody's business every day.

0:33:8.200 --> 0:33:10.540

FR07

And if you look at over the over the years.

0:33:11.210 --> 0:33:14.940

FR07

These are the guys that I come in with that left the fire service.

0:33:15.560 --> 0:33:16.280

FR07

Too early?

0:33:19.670 --> 0:33:21.190

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:33:22.190 --> 0:33:28.620

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what I mean, what are your thoughts regarding mindfulness and then corporation and mindful practices into the daily work life?

0:33:29.540 --> 0:33:30.310

FR07

Well.

0:33:31.770 --> 0:33:35.240

FR07

I think it needs to be, you know, we educate guys.

0:33:36.10 --> 0:33:42.880

FR07

On the job, you mean how to be a fireman? What do you do in this situation? We educate guys in EMS.

0:33:44.560 --> 0:34:2.200

FR07

What do you do in this situation? There's a lot of guys that come out of school that don't know how to take care of themselves. They don't have a physical fitness background like I did. I was fortunate. I mean, I I was blessed in that department. There's a lot of things I didn't know. I mean, I wish somebody to educated me on.

0:34:4.750 --> 0:34:16.170

FR07

How to be a better father or you know, something at home? I wish we'd had, you know, financial. I didn't have a good financial background. I didn't do very good early in my career in taking care of my finances.

0:34:19.760 --> 0:34:32.10

FR07

I just wish they would educate, allow us to educate each other a little bit more. And didn't you know if it was supported by the upper echelon, the, you know supported? I think you could do a lot more with these guys.

0:34:34.420 --> 0:34:36.730

FR07

Such as when you go into the NFL.

0:34:39.90 --> 0:34:45.420

FR07

Yeah, I have some friends that are NFL players and and when you go into the NFL, they sit out and talk to you about finances.

0:34:46.200 --> 0:35:2.370

FR07

They just sit there. There's a play, there's somebody you can call if you're if you're having problems with your, with your home life, there's somebody there for different, different avenues. If you don't feel good, we can call this doc. If you this is going on, we can call this.

0:35:3.200 --> 0:35:3.990

FR07

I've kind of.

0:35:5.250 --> 0:35:6.240

FR07

In in, in.

0:35:7.170 --> 0:35:11.860

FR07

In our department, I put a physical fitness plan together and we've hired a physical trainer.

0:35:12.870 --> 0:35:18.260

FR07

We've hired a a physical therapist that comes in.

0:35:19.270 --> 0:35:32.40

FR07

We've done some things like that, but I've tried to. I've tried to go a little bit further and come in with guys. We we now have a a, A, a guy that does helps us with.

0:35:32.640 --> 0:35:34.730

FR07

Umm. Our finances?

0:35:36.300 --> 0:35:42.910

FR07

But we've we've lacked the people like you guys to come in and help us with.

0:35:43.610 --> 0:35:55.180

FR07

You know our medical. What are we thinking? How you know? How is your home life doing? What is what's going on here? What's going on there? We had to go out and find that on our own. And it was very frustrating.

0:35:58.530 --> 0:36:1.450

FR07

Going through [SEVERAL] different doctors.

0:36:3.20 --> 0:36:6.450

FR07

Mental mental to help with my mental side.

0:36:8.70 --> 0:36:14.50

FR07

I'm gonna tell you I almost made a couple bad decisions and it was.

0:36:15.200 --> 0:36:16.480

FR07

It it wouldn't have been good.

0:36:17.870 --> 0:36:19.560

FR07

And that's and that's sad.

0:36:20.390 --> 0:36:23.220

FR07

Because I feel like these guys really got a lot to give.

0:36:23.980 --> 0:36:27.510

FR07

And when they feel like there's nowhere no way to get nowhere to go.

0:36:29.660 --> 0:36:30.60

FR07

That.

0:36:31.350 --> 0:36:37.320

FR07

That's sad and we got a lot of those guys. I mean, there's more than you think that are out there. They're just surviving every day.

0:36:38.110 --> 0:36:42.350

FR07

Look at our divorce rate. I mean, if you don't look at anything else, just look at our divorce rate.

0:36:46.0 --> 0:36:47.750

FR07

I mean, it's it's astronomical.

0:36:50.410 --> 0:36:51.620

INTERVIEWER - MW

You know I'm.

0:36:53.40 --> 0:37:2.420

INTERVIEWER - MW

In these interviews, you know, we've heard, you know, you're really alluding to this, this team concept in this mentality and and one of the.

0:37:3.410 --> 0:37:10.760

INTERVIEWER - MW

One of the things we're really looking to drill down into is like how are we gonna deliver this thing? Is it, do we focus on your guys's?

0:37:12.130 --> 0:37:36.970

INTERVIEWER - MW

Erratic schedules and make it really bite size so you guys can you know it's real convenient or do we we do something that is centered around cultivating more this team environment, saying, like everyone's gonna win possible we're going to come together and we're gonna spend a little bit of time doing some of this programming together to create some. There's some momentum around it. What do you think? Like, what are your thoughts around that?

0:37:39.630 --> 0:37:39.910

INTERVIEWER - MW

Hmm.

0:37:36.10 --> 0:37:43.520

FR07

I think it needs to be both. I honestly think it needs to be both. I think we need to be educated on the signs.

0:37:44.630 --> 0:37:48.90

FR07

I wish somebody would have educated me on the signs of.

0:37:49.90 --> 0:37:56.910

FR07

Of what was going on with me before I subjected my family to all these problems.

0:37:57.630 --> 0:38:0.190

FR07

I mean, as a professional guy, I'm awesome.

0:38:1.710 --> 0:38:9.120

FR07

I mean, I don't wanna sit here and go. Dude, this guy's as a as a as a as a personal. My personal, I'm a moron.

0:38:10.760 --> 0:38:12.360

FR07

Dude, I am terrible.

0:38:13.680 --> 0:38:14.240

FR07

With that.

0:38:15.360 --> 0:38:17.370

FR07

And if somebody would have pointed out.

0:38:19.430 --> 0:38:20.40

FR07

You know.

0:38:21.330 --> 0:38:23.10

FR07

Some of these things that.

0:38:24.130 --> 0:38:24.840

FR07

You know.

0:38:26.540 --> 0:38:34.370

FR07

Would show up and and and help our families, you know, maybe a resource that my wife could have called and said, hey.

0:38:35.200 --> 0:38:39.340

FR07

Just just to put it out there, what do you think about us coming in and talking to you today?

0:38:40.340 --> 0:38:41.940

FR07

Uh, maybe my kids.

0:38:43.540 --> 0:38:58.680

FR07

You know, again, we're all a family. You know yourself and I don't. And I don't know you from Adam, but you know yourself if if you didn't have a good communication with your wife and you come into the office that morning, that kind of plays on you.

0:39:0.170 --> 0:39:3.900

FR07

In in. Again, here's here. And here's my scenario.

0:39:4.690 --> 0:39:25.590

FR07

I I had a you know you have a a disagreement or a a a misunderstanding at home and I go in and and at 8:01 my my shift starts at 8 o'clock at 8:01 the tone goes off and I get the first two alarm fire of the day and I'm not quite thinking of what's going on.

0:39:26.530 --> 0:39:30.840

FR07

And me and my partner fall through a floor or get blown out because I'm not paying attention.

0:39:32.40 --> 0:39:32.840

FR07

That's a problem.

0:39:34.440 --> 0:39:42.710

FR07

And that happens all the time. Luckily, somebody's there to pull us back or, you know, help us or something goes on.

0:39:43.830 --> 0:39:47.830

FR07

Because guys come into the come into work and they're a little distraught at times.

0:39:48.480 --> 0:39:51.950

FR07

But if they had an avenue to fix that before it got to that point.

0:39:52.680 --> 0:39:54.320

FR07

Just like we do with physical fitness.

0:39:55.670 --> 0:39:57.920

FR07

You're a little weaker here. Well, let's work on this.

0:40:0.40 --> 0:40:4.910

FR07

You guys can have a little bit of problem. Let's work on this. Tom, you can't talk to your wife that way.

0:40:6.390 --> 0:40:7.70

FR07

You know what I mean?

0:40:8.90 --> 0:40:10.760

FR07

You can't. You can't tell your kids.

0:40:11.550 --> 0:40:20.300

FR07

This stuff you can't. You can't talk to him that way. I wish somebody would have, you know, everybody told me what I wanted to hear. Nobody ever told me what I needed to hear.

0:40:22.150 --> 0:40:25.490

FR07

And that's the whole problem with FR07. I'm a pretty strong guy.

0:40:27.400 --> 0:40:28.280

FR07

And like I said.

0:40:28.970 --> 0:40:32.250

FR07

In the professional realm I I did what I was supposed to do.

0:40:33.120 --> 0:40:42.520

FR07

You know, you gave me a task. I I did it in fire school and and medic school and riding in a helicopter. Dude, they made you feel like you were God.

0:40:43.210 --> 0:40:44.780

FR07

You step off that helicopter.

0:40:45.770 --> 0:40:49.520

FR07

Everything the the you know the light shining on you, you're it.

0:40:50.490 --> 0:40:51.900

FR07

Well, that mentality.

0:40:53.450 --> 0:40:56.420

FR07

That mentality made me think that I was somebody.

0:40:58.730 --> 0:41:2.130

FR07

So when I failed or I couldn't get something done.

0:41:3.330 --> 0:41:4.710

FR07

Dude, it destroyed you.

0:41:6.70 --> 0:41:7.680

FR07

I mean, think of the NFL guy.

0:41:8.500 --> 0:41:11.780

FR07

That plays great for two years and all of a sudden he gets an injury.

0:41:14.460 --> 0:41:15.670

FR07

What happens to this guy?

0:41:17.300 --> 0:41:18.360

FR07

He's destroyed.

0:41:20.50 --> 0:41:23.500

FR07

I mean, you read about them all the time. We're the same guys.

0:41:25.150 --> 0:41:30.540

FR07

We're the same that we have to succeed. There's not an option I have to fix your problem.

0:41:32.130 --> 0:41:40.730

FR07

Whether it's a house fire or gas leak or auto accident or your medically, I have to fix your problem.

0:41:42.530 --> 0:41:43.460

FR07

It's not an option.

0:41:46.490 --> 0:41:47.220

FR07

What if I can't?

0:41:49.820 --> 0:41:51.170

FR07

What if I fail that day?

0:41:53.20 --> 0:41:54.20

FR07

Now, what are we talk about?

0:41:57.900 --> 0:42:2.450

FR07

I'm gonna tell you who's talking now. It's the wife sitting at home. It's getting her ass beat.

0:42:3.640 --> 0:42:5.680

FR07

From all the things that I say when I come home.

0:42:7.900 --> 0:42:8.730

FR07

That can't happen.

0:42:10.270 --> 0:42:17.30

FR07

Because I lost. I'm telling you, [DESCRIBES THE "LOSS" OF SPOUSE AND CHILDREN AFTER DIVORCE].

0:42:18.310 --> 0:42:19.100

FR07

We had everything.

0:42:20.650 --> 0:42:23.310

FR07

And I let this career destroy it.

0:42:26.320 --> 0:42:30.470

FR07

Because I didn't have anywhere else to go and it almost destroyed me.

0:42:31.970 --> 0:42:34.890

FR07

Personally I mean physically, mentally.

0:42:35.680 --> 0:42:37.580

FR07

Yeah, I almost did things that I should have done.

0:42:41.410 --> 0:42:49.80

INTERVIEWER - MW

That being said, I mean what? What type of information is important to include in anything that we're going to do to make sure that we're?

0:42:50.200 --> 0:42:50.950

INTERVIEWER - MW

We're effective.

0:42:50.130 --> 0:42:52.320

FR07

We have to know we can trust you.

0:42:54.720 --> 0:42:58.760

FR07

We have to know that you that we're not just a.

0:42:59.470 --> 0:43:6.400

FR07

In the thing the reason why I'll tell you another reason why I got on this is because I listened to you guys this thing and and you were.

0:43:8.320 --> 0:43:17.50

FR07

How do I say that? And I don't mean this to be so. What? I tell you something. Please don't take it. I I everybody wants to diagnose us with post traumatic stress syndrome.

0:43:17.720 --> 0:43:21.100

FR07

OK. That's a great. That's a, that's a great article.

0:43:22.770 --> 0:43:39.570

FR07

But there's housewives diagnosed with post traumatic stress syndrome. There's guys that here to post Traumatic Stress syndrome in this, everybody has post traumatic stress syndrome to the kids in the high school. All of them have post traumatic stress syndrome in them because they're worried about somebody coming in and shooting them.

0:43:41.420 --> 0:43:46.490

FR07

I get it. I I totally get it. You can't put us all in the same.

0:43:47.330 --> 0:43:52.70

FR07

basket and expect these guys to go dude. They understand what I'm doing.

0:43:54.480 --> 0:44:3.410

FR07

Looking down the barrel of a gun of a cop getting ready to get shot is not the same thing as a firefighter can't get in. Somebody intubated today.

0:44:5.710 --> 0:44:10.680

FR07

It's not the same thing. I've looked down the barrel of a gun. Trust me, it's not the same thing.

0:44:15.860 --> 0:44:18.820

FR07

So when you put everybody in the same barrel.

0:44:20.120 --> 0:44:23.270

FR07

And you're trying to get the the a different result.

0:44:24.810 --> 0:44:25.640

FR07

It's not working.

0:44:27.840 --> 0:44:29.510

FR07

These guys aren't taking you serious.

0:44:30.480 --> 0:44:31.780

FR07

They don't think you care.

0:44:32.580 --> 0:44:33.740

FR07

We're just another number.

0:44:36.850 --> 0:44:47.190

FR07

And that's where it was for me. Like I said, in the [SEVERAL] therapists I went to, I pay [AMOUNT OF FEE] every time I walk into this therapist office.

0:44:48.220 --> 0:44:50.740

FR07

Every time, because my insurance won't cover her.

0:44:53.510 --> 0:44:56.140

FR07

\$178 every time I walk in the door.

0:44:57.900 --> 0:44:59.800

FR07

And the department doesn't pick up 1 dime of it.

0:45:3.460 --> 0:45:6.980

FR07

Do I think it's important? Absolutely. I'd pay. I I have to pay it.

0:45:8.50 --> 0:45:10.260

FR07

Because I never want to go back to being that guy was.

0:45:14.200 --> 0:45:14.510

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:45:14.320 --> 0:45:20.710

FR07

I never want to feel like there's never any options, never an option like I did. I had myself talked into no options.

0:45:28.230 --> 0:45:35.420

INTERVIEWER - MW

Man, I mean that's that's our questions. You've you've really illuminated a lot of things really thankful for you sharing all this stuff and just.

0:45:36.130 --> 0:45:40.860

INTERVIEWER - MW

Before we part any, anything that we miss, you wanna make sure you send us off on a.

0:45:45.620 --> 0:45:45.910

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:45:39.970 --> 0:45:47.600

FR07

Like I said, I just please don't think that I'm trying to tell you that you guys, I we want help. We want help. We need help.

0:45:48.850 --> 0:45:56.480

FR07

We need it. I mean, if you want, if if you want your Fire Protection, your first responders to excel.

0:45:59.990 --> 0:46:0.640

FR07

Like I said.

0:46:1.450 --> 0:46:11.190

FR07

We've got people out there doing the fitness side of it. We got people out there doing, you know, some that we need help, man, we need help bad and these guys are hurting.

0:46:12.240 --> 0:46:15.480

FR07

And if you guys want to do anything like that.

0:46:17.200 --> 0:46:25.670

FR07

You guys, it would be awesome because I'm it. It it. It's not gonna stay the same. There's not people wanting to be in this business anymore.

0:46:26.390 --> 0:46:26.670

INTERVIEWER - MW

Uh.

[DESCRIBES THE START OF CAREER AS VERY COMPETITIVE].

0:46:53.650 --> 0:46:58.130

FR07

When we when we started 25 years ago.

0:46:59.400 --> 0:47:0.170

FR07

We had.

0:47:1.160 --> 0:47:1.880

FR07

Probably.

0:47:3.170 --> 0:47:7.310

FR07

Seven, 800 guys taking the test for the fire department.

0:47:9.280 --> 0:47:10.690

FR07

15 years ago.

0:47:11.550 --> 0:47:13.680

FR07

We had six, 700.

0:47:15.800 --> 0:47:16.760

FR07

Last year.

0:47:17.810 --> 0:47:19.320

FR07

We had 32.

0:47:19.970 --> 0:47:21.760

FR07

They've got three on the list right now.

0:47:23.690 --> 0:47:24.800

FR07

[THE OTHER STATION].

0:47:26.80 --> 0:47:35.810

FR07

Has needs. I think 6 classes, 7 classes to just keep up with the guys that are gonna leave this year. That's not counting the ones that's left in the last.

0:47:36.470 --> 0:47:37.140

FR07

Three years.

0:47:38.380 --> 0:47:43.330

FR07

[THE POLICE STATION] is down over 600 officers right now, 600.

0:47:46.640 --> 0:47:49.70

FR07

They can't get enough people to take to sign up.

0:47:50.920 --> 0:47:52.870

FR07

So if you want your forces.

0:47:54.110 --> 0:47:56.370

FR07

To be as good as they ever have been.

0:47:58.970 --> 0:48:0.500

FR07

Somebody has to do something.

0:48:3.0 --> 0:48:13.370

FR07

And people don't want to do this job because they're looking at guys like me. Like I said, brother, I live in a beautiful home. I live on 10 acres out here in the middle of nowhere. It is absolutely beautiful.

0:48:14.820 --> 0:48:16.760

FR07

There's not a soul that walks through this house.

0:48:17.910 --> 0:48:19.160

FR07

Because I run everybody out.

0:48:22.910 --> 0:48:24.340

FR07

It's the most it's the.

0:48:25.790 --> 0:48:29.260

FR07

Nobody, I mean, like I said, they love who we are out there.

0:48:31.410 --> 0:48:34.320

FR07

But 2/3 of our life, people can't stand to be around us.

0:48:38.980 --> 0:48:39.780

FR07

We just need help.

0:48:41.360 --> 0:48:41.680

INTERVIEWER - MW

You know.

0:48:46.440 --> 0:48:46.680

FR07

This is.

0:48:46.120 --> 0:48:48.170

INTERVIEWER - MW

This is awesome, this was.